The Selling closure

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Abstract

A lattice with a right angle has several Selling-reduced cells; Kurlin (2026) showed that there are at most sixteen. This paper treats the set of all of them, with the integer changes of basis between them, as one object, the Selling closure. The closure contains every lattice symmetry and every operator between alternative reduced cells. Symmetries relate only cells of identical shape, and in the lattice types with right angles most of the point group is not visible in any single reduced cell: none of the three twofolds of a primitive orthorhombic lattice relabels its reduced cell. The structure of the closure is fixed by which conorms vanish and which are equal, so there is one closure per Delone sort, and the 24 sorts are reproduced from the six possible patterns of vanishing conorms. For measured cells, near-congruence within a conorm band τ is defined and shown to be decided by a widened closure, Selling reduction with its boundary moved to $-\tau$. The widened closure is unique, is the union of the exact closures of all lattices within the band, and is computed completely by idealising the cell onto its nearest pattern of zeros at 4τ, enumerating the exact closure there, and

filtering with the measured metric; walks from the measured cell miss members. From a single reduced cell of a new cell the reindexing operator onto a reference is then found, with a stated guarantee.

1. Introduction

Two questions recur in indexing and data processing. What are the symmetries of a lattice? And are two cells the same lattice, and if so by which integer matrix? Both are usually answered by searching: for symmetry, a scan for near-twofolds within an angular tolerance (Le Page, 1982); for reindexing, a list of small integer matrices, or the operators of the point group just found. Neither search comes with a statement that it is complete, and both are complicated by the same fact: a lattice with a right angle has more than one reduced cell, and the alternatives are related by integer matrices that are not symmetries.

Selling reduction makes the multiplicity explicit. A lattice on a right angle has several obtuse superbases; Kurlin (2026) proved that there are never more than sixteen and listed them by lattice type. We take the whole set, with the integer matrices between its members, as the object of study and call it the *Selling closure*. The term is introduced here; Kurlin's results concern the set of obtuse superbases.

The paper asks what the closure contains, how it behaves for measured cells, and what that gives for reindexing. Section 2 defines the operators and introduces one monoclinic cell that is used throughout. Section 3 describes the computations. Section 4 gives the results: the structure of the closure and its dependence on the Delone sort; near-congruence of measured cells within a band and its complete computation; and reindexing from a single reduced cell. The relation to earlier work is set out in Section 5. Proofs are in Appendix A, the conversion of a measurement error into a band in Appendix B, and every number in the text carries a mark [*znn*] naming the

computational check that reproduces it (Appendix C).

2. The Selling closure

2.1. Superbases, conorms and the metric tensor

Selling reduction works with four vectors rather than three: the cell vectors a, b, c and $d = -a - b - c$. The four form a *superbase*; any three of them are a basis of the lattice. The six negated pair products

$$p_{ab} = -a \cdot b, \quad p_{ac} = -a \cdot c, \quad p_{bc} = -b \cdot c, \quad p_{ad} = -a \cdot d, \quad p_{bd} = -b \cdot d, \quad p_{cd} = -c \cdot d$$

are the *conorms* (Selling, 1874; Conway & Sloane, 1992). The Selling parameters of the S^6 formalism (Andrews *et al.*, 2019) are the same six numbers with the opposite sign, listed in the order $b \cdot c$, $a \cdot c$, $a \cdot b$, $a \cdot d$, $b \cdot d$, $c \cdot d$; that order is used for the sort patterns of Table 4, and the order da, db, dc, ab, ac, bc elsewhere. A superbase is *obtuse*, which is to say Selling-reduced, when all six conorms are non-negative. The metric tensor in the basis (a, b, c) is linear in the conorms,

$$\mathbf{G} = \begin{pmatrix} p_{ab} + p_{ac} + p_{ad} & -p_{ab} & -p_{ac} \\ -p_{ab} & p_{ab} + p_{bc} + p_{bd} & -p_{bc} \\ -p_{ac} & -p_{bc} & p_{ac} + p_{bc} + p_{cd} \end{pmatrix}, \tag{1}$$

so the conorms are an alternative set of six cell parameters, and a change to the conorms is a change to the cell with nothing to reconstruct. A conorm that is exactly zero is a right angle between two of the four vectors; this paper calls a zero conorm a *wall*, after the boundary it forms in the space of cells, and the set of slots that vanish the *zero pattern* of the cell. Only six zero patterns are possible if the four vectors are to remain connected by non-zero conorms: no zero; one; two sharing a vector; two disjoint; three forming a triangle; three forming a path.

2.2. The Selling operators

Two kinds of integer operator act on a superbase, and every operator in this paper is a product of them.

Flips. A flip at the conorm p_{ab} replaces a by $-a$ and adds the old a to the two other vectors: $(a, b, c, d) \mapsto (-a,\ b,\ c+a,\ d+a)$. It changes the sign of p_{ab}. Selling reduction applies flips at negative conorms until none remain; the sum of the conorms decreases at each step, so it stops, at an obtuse superbase. A flip at a conorm that is exactly zero carries one obtuse superbase to another obtuse superbase of the same lattice, which is why the reduced cell of a lattice with a right angle is not unique. With the basis (a, b, c) each of the six flips is a fixed 3×3 integer matrix of determinant -1 that is its own inverse (Table 1). The flips are the boundary transformations of Andrews *et al.* (2019), written on the basis rather than on the six Selling parameters.

Table 1. *The six Selling flips as* 3×3 *integer matrices in the basis* (a, b, c), $d = -a - b - c$; *columns are the new basis vectors in the old basis. Each has determinant* -1 *and squares to the identity. The second column gives the flip as a setting change in the notation of crystallographic software.*

flip at	new basis	matrix
$a \cdot b$	$(-a,\ b,\ a+c)$	$\begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$
$a \cdot c$	$(-a,\ a+b,\ c)$	$\begin{pmatrix} -1 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$
$b \cdot c$	$(a+b,\ -b,\ c)$	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$
$a \cdot d$	$(a,\ -a-c,\ -a-b)$	$\begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 & -1 \\ 0 & -1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$
$b \cdot d$	$(-b-c,\ b,\ -a-b)$	$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & -1 \\ -1 & 1 & -1 \\ -1 & 0 & 0 \end{pmatrix}$
$c \cdot d$	$(-b-c,\ -a-c,\ c)$	$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 & 0 \\ -1 & 0 & 0 \\ -1 & -1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}$

Swaps. A superbase is an unordered set of four vectors up to a common sign, so one reduced cell can be written in $4! \times 2 = 48$ ways. The 48 reorderings and sign changes

are the swaps. They change which three vectors are called a, b, c and in which order, and nothing else.

Products, and symmetries among them. A sequence of flips at zero conorms followed by a swap carries a reduced cell to a reduced cell of the same lattice, possibly one of different shape, and every integer matrix that carries a reduced cell to a reduced cell is such a product (Kurlin, 2026; Lemma A5). A lattice symmetry is an integer matrix g with $g^{\mathsf{T}}\mathbf{G}g = \mathbf{G}$; it carries reduced cells to reduced cells, so it is one of these products. Which products are symmetries depends on the conorm values, not on the operators: a product is a symmetry for exactly those lattices whose conorms it leaves unchanged. The twofold rotations are the symmetries that matter in practice: together with the inversion they generate the point group of any lattice, which is the basis of the Le Page (1982) search and is used in the same way by Lebedev *et al.* (2006).

2.3. The closure, and one cell used throughout

The *Selling closure* $\mathcal{G}(\mathbf{G})$ of a lattice is the set of all its obtuse superbases, each counted once up to swaps, together with the products of flips and swaps between them. Kurlin (2026) proved that the set has 1, 2, 3, 6 or 16 members according to the lattice type and that flips at zero conorms reach all of them. The members, as integer combinations of the reduced cell vectors, and the operators between them are the same for every lattice with the same zero pattern (Kurlin, 2026, Lemmas 4.1–4.5, which list them); only the conorm values differ.

Take $a = 30$, $b = 40$, $c = 50\,\text{Å}$, $\beta = 100°$. Its reduced superbase is $M_0 = (d, a, b, c)$ with conorms

$$p_{ab} = 0, \quad p_{bc} = 0, \quad p_{ac} = 260.5, \quad p_{ad} = 639.5, \quad p_{bd} = 1600.0, \quad p_{cd} = 2239.5\ \text{Å}^2.$$

The two walls are the right angles α and γ at the twofold axis b, present in every primitive monoclinic lattice. No other conorm is small, so the lattice is not near a

higher symmetry.[z46] The closure has six members (Table 2); each has two walls, each flip leads to a neighbour, and the six form a ring M_0–M_1–M_5–M_4–M_3–M_2–M_0. All six carry the same six conorm values in different positions, and in its own basis each is, in general, a differently shaped cell.

Table 2. *The Selling closure of the monoclinic cell $a = 30$, $b = 40$, $c = 50$ Å, $\beta = 100°$: six obtuse superbases, each up to the order and common sign of its vectors, and the flips at zero conorms that connect them.*

member	four vectors	zero-conorm flips lead to
M_0	$-a-b-c,\ a,\ b,\ c$	M_1, M_2
M_1	$-b-c,\ -a,\ b,\ a+c$	M_0, M_5
M_2	$-a-c,\ a+b,\ -b,\ c$	M_0, M_3
M_3	$a+c,\ b-c,\ -b,\ -a$	M_2, M_4
M_4	$a-b+c,\ -c,\ b,\ -a$	M_3, M_5
M_5	$a-b,\ c,\ b,\ -a-c$	M_1, M_4

The point group is $2/m$. Each of its four operations carries M_0 to a member (Table 3).[z46] The identity and the inversion carry M_0 to itself: they are swaps of M_0, and visible in it. The twofold sends $(a, b, c) \mapsto (-a, b, -c)$ and so carries $(-a-b-c, a, b, c)$ to $(a-b+c, -a, b, -c)$, which is not a reordering of M_0 but the member M_4, three flips away; the mirror does the same. Read in the twofold's order, $(-a, b, -c)$, the basis of M_4 has the metric tensor of (a, b, c); read in the order of Table 2, $(-c, b, -a)$, it has a different one, with 639.5 and 2239.5 exchanged.[z46] In the operators of Section 2.2, the twofold is the flips $a \cdot b$, $b \cdot c$, $d \cdot b$ — the path $M_0 \to M_1 \to M_5 \to M_4$ — followed by the swap $-(d, a, c, b)$, and the mirror the same flips with the swap (d, a, c, b).[z46] Half of the point group is therefore not visible in the reduced cell: it consists of operators between reduced cells.

Table 3. *The four symmetries of the monoclinic lattice of Table 2, applied to the reduced cell M_0. Matrices act on coordinates in the basis a, b, c.*

symmetry	matrix	M_0 is carried to	visible in M_0
1	$\mathrm{diag}(1, 1, 1)$	M_0	yes, a swap of M_0
$\bar{1}$	$\mathrm{diag}(-1, -1, -1)$	M_0	yes, a swap of M_0
2 along b	$\mathrm{diag}(-1, 1, -1)$	M_4	no
m normal to b	$\mathrm{diag}(1, -1, 1)$	M_4	no

2.4. Delone sorts

Delone (1932) classified lattices into 24 sorts by the pattern of zeros and equalities among the reduced Selling parameters, each sort lying in one Bravais type and some Bravais types comprising several sorts; the 24 patterns, with the symbols C1 to A3 used below, are listed by Andrews *et al.* (2023). The sorts are the Selling counterpart of the 44 Niggli lattice characters: they split a Bravais type by the shape of the cell, not by its symmetry. Since the closure's structure depends only on the zero pattern and its symmetries on the equalities, the sort is the natural unit for describing closures.

2.5. Measured cells

A measured cell is never exactly on a wall: a right angle is measured as 90.25° and the conorm is a small number of either sign. The band τ, in Å^2, is the tolerance within which a conorm counts as zero; Appendix B says how a declared error on the metric tensor is converted into τ, and the worked measured cell below has $\tau = 43.2\,\text{Å}^2$ for a metric error of $14.4\,\text{Å}^2$. The *widened closure* of a metric at band τ is

$$\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}) = \big\{\, F \;:\; \text{all six conorms of } F \text{ under } \mathbf{G} \text{ are } \geq -\tau \,\big\}, \tag{2}$$

the superbases that Selling reduction would accept with its boundary moved from 0 to $-\tau$. The *depth* of a superbase is the size of its most negative conorm, so it belongs to the widened closure when its depth is at most τ, and its depth is the band at which it enters. Two cells are τ-*congruent* when some reduced superbase of one, carried by an integer operator $\mathbf{P}$ onto the other, has each of its six conorms agreeing to within τ under the two metrics; exact congruence, $\mathbf{P}^\mathsf{T}\mathbf{G}\mathbf{P} = \mathbf{G}'$, is the case $\tau = 0$. Finally, λ_1 denotes the squared length of the shortest lattice vector, and the *price* of an operator on a measured cell is the residual $\|\mathbf{P}^\mathsf{T}\mathbf{G}\mathbf{P} - \mathbf{G}\|_F$, the amount by which it fails to be a symmetry.

3. Methods

3.1. Closures and symmetries by sort

For each of the 24 sorts a generic lattice was built from its pattern with random values for the free parameters. Its closure was enumerated by flips at the exact zeros from the reduced superbase, and its symmetries found by testing every member, in every order and sign of its four vectors, against the metric tensor. Symmetries carrying the reduced superbase to itself were counted separately from those carrying it elsewhere. Members were grouped into shapes — the same conorm vector up to swaps — and into orbits under the symmetries.

3.2. Reproducing the sorts

For each of the six zero patterns a generic lattice was built and its closure enumerated. Each member, in each order of its vectors, rearranges the six conorm values; the rearrangements that keep the zeros in place form a finite set of permutations. A pattern of equal conorms was accepted as a sort when imposing it on a generic lattice produced a lattice whose symmetries enforce exactly those equalities and no others, and patterns that describe the same lattices from different members were counted once. No Bravais types or point groups were supplied.

3.3. Measured cells: idealise, enumerate, filter

The widened closure of equation (2) is computed as follows.

1. Selling-reduce the measured cell to a superbase F_0.

2. Set every conorm of F_0 that is at most 4τ to zero, all at once, and form the metric tensor $\mathbf{G}^*$ of the result by equation (1). This is the *idealised lattice* Λ^*; it has an exact zero pattern.

3. Enumerate the exact closure of Λ^* by flips at its zeros, keeping each member as

integer combinations of F_0 — equivalently, keeping the operators $\mathbf{W}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{W}_m$ from F_0 to each member.

4. Evaluate each member with the *measured* metric tensor and keep those whose six conorms are all at least $-\tau$. Record each member's depth.

The operators of step 3 are integer matrices independent of the metric, so they are the same for Λ^* and for the measured cell; the measured metric enters only in step 4. Section 4.3 proves that this returns exactly $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G})$.

3.4. Reindexing from one reduced cell

A reference R is stored as its widened closure in integer coordinates. A new cell N is reduced once; its reduced superbase paired with each stored member, in each order and sign, gives a candidate operator $\mathbf{P}$ with $\mathbf{G}_N \approx \mathbf{P}^{\mathsf{T}}\mathbf{G}_R\mathbf{P}$, ranked by its price in R's frame.

3.5. Verification

Closure memberships were checked against brute force: every superbase with coordinates in $[-2, 2]$ relative to F_0 (135 408 bases of determinant ± 1) tested against equation (2). Symmetry counts and sort derivations were exhaustive. Test lattices were specified by their conorms. The measured worked cell is 30.02, 39.97, 50.03 Å, 90.25°, 92.05°, 89.80°: the cell 30–40–50 Å, $\beta = 92°$, which sits on two walls, perturbed by 14.4 Å^2 in the Frobenius norm of its metric tensor. The checks are the test files of Appendix C.

4. Results

4.1. What the closure contains

Table 4 gives the closure of each sort. Out of each member there are exactly as many symmetry operators as the point group has elements, and in every sort that number is the order of the holohedry: 48, 24, 16, 12, 8, 4 or 2.[z46] The twofolds, with the inversion, generate the group in every sort, so finding the twofolds suffices.[z46]

Table 4. *The Selling closure of each Delone sort, for a generic lattice of the pattern. Patterns are Selling parameters in the* S^6 *order* $b\cdot c, a\cdot c, a\cdot b, a\cdot d, b\cdot d, c\cdot d$*; equal letters denote equal values and* 0 *a zero. Members are counted up to swaps. "Visible" is the number of symmetries that carry the reduced superbase to itself; the rest carry it to another member. "Shapes" is the number of distinct cell shapes among the members, equal in every case to the number of orbits of members under the symmetries. "Visible" depends on which member one reduces to; values are for the pattern as written.*

sort	Bravais	pattern	zeros	members	|group|	visible	shapes
C1	cI	rrrrrr	0	1	48	48	1
C3	cF	rr0rr0	2	3	48	16	1
C5	cP	000rrr	3	16	48	12	2
H4	hP	00rrrs	2	6	24	4	1
T1	tI	rrsrrs	0	1	16	16	1
T2	tI	rr0rrs	1	2	16	8	1
T5	tP	000rrs	3	16	16	4	3
R1	hR	rrrsss	0	1	12	12	1
R3	hR	rr0sr0	2	3	12	4	1
O1A	oF	rrsrrt	0	1	8	8	1
O1B	oI	rstrst	0	1	8	8	1
O2	oI	rs0srt	1	2	8	4	1
O3	oI	rs0rs0	2	3	8	8	2
O4	oS	00rsst	2	6	8	4	2
O5	oP	000rst	3	16	8	2	4
M1A	mC	rrsttu	0	1	4	4	1
M1B	mC	rstrsu	0	1	4	4	1
M2A	mC	rs0stu	1	2	4	2	1
M2B	mC	rs0rst	1	2	4	4	2
M3	mC	rs0ts0	2	3	4	4	2
M4	mP	00rstu	2	6	4	2	3
A1	aP	rstuvw	0	1	2	2	1
A2	aP	rs0tuv	1	2	2	2	2
A3	aP	rs0tu0	2	3	2	2	3

Zero pattern and sort fix different parts. Which members exist and which operators join them is fixed by the zero pattern; which of the operators are symmetries is fixed by the sort, and the abstract group by the Bravais type. Primitive monoclinic, C-centred orthorhombic and primitive hexagonal lattices all have two zeros and six members and

differ only in how many operators are symmetries (4, 8, 24). Body-centred tetragonal lattices have no zero below $c/a = \sqrt{2}$ and one zero above it, and C-centred monoclinic lattices occupy five sorts with three zero patterns, depending on the cell shape; the sort boundary is where a symmetry-forced right angle enters or leaves the reduced cell, with no change of symmetry. Within one sort the shape plays no part: the members, the operators and the symmetries are the same, and the lattice supplies only the numbers attached to them.

Symmetry visible in one cell. In the sorts with walls the symmetries that relabel the reduced cell are a minority: 2 of 8 for primitive orthorhombic, 4 of 16 for primitive tetragonal, 12 of 48 for primitive cubic, 4 of 24 for hexagonal, 4 of 12 for rhombohedral R3.[z46] For the twofolds alone: none of the three twofolds of a primitive orthorhombic lattice relabels its reduced cell, nor the one twofold of primitive monoclinic; of the five, nine and seven of primitive tetragonal, cubic and hexagonal, one, three and one do.[z46] The rest are short flip words to other members.

Cell shapes. Out of M_0 in the monoclinic example there are $48 \times 6 = 288$ operators, one to each labelling of each member; four are symmetries and 284 relate M_0 to differently shaped cells. In every sort two members are related by a symmetry exactly when they have the same shape, so the number of shapes equals the number of symmetry orbits (last column of Table 4), and no symmetry ever relates cells of different shape.[z46] The monoclinic cell has three shapes: $\{M_0, M_4\}$ is 30, 40, 50 Å, $\beta = 100°$; $\{M_1, M_3\}$ is 30, 40, 53.7 Å, $\beta = 113.4°$, the alternative choice $a + c$; $\{M_2, M_5\}$ is a third.[z46] Two measurements that reduce to M_0 and to M_1 report different cell parameters and are related by no symmetry, only by the flip at $a \cdot b$. Ten of the 24 sorts have more than one shape; primitive orthorhombic has four.

4.2. The 24 sorts reproduced

The procedure of Section 3.2, starting from six zero patterns, returns exactly 24 patterns of equal conorms, and they are Delone's, as listed by Andrews *et al.* (2023), none missing and none extra.[z48] The point groups, not supplied, come out as the holohedries, and the member counts as Kurlin's 1, 2, 3, 6 and 16.[z48] The three patterns that Andrews *et al.* describe as degenerate boundaries (O3, M2B, M3), which lie on the boundary between two other sorts of the same Bravais type, arise like the others. This confirms Delone's classification from the closure alone and gives it an operational reading: a sort is a pattern of zeros and equalities such that a lattice with that pattern has exactly the symmetries the pattern implies.

4.3. Near-congruence within a band

The measured problem. For the measured monoclinic cell with $\alpha = 90.25°$, the conorms p_{ab} and p_{bc} are small numbers of either sign. The flips that gave M_1 and M_2 now give superbases with a slightly negative conorm, Selling reduction rejects them, and the exact closure has one member instead of six; the twofold and the mirror, which were operators to M_4, now lead to a cell that is not in the set.

What the widened closure is. Equation (2) names no starting cell, order of operations or frame, so $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G})$ is the same whoever computes it. By Proposition 1 (Appendix A) a superbase belongs to it exactly when it is the exactly reduced superbase of some lattice within τ of $\mathbf{G}$ in that superbase's own conorms: the widened closure is the union of the exact closures of all lattices consistent with the measurement. The cell at which reduction with a $-\tau$ boundary stops is not well defined: from 400 random starting bases, reduction of the measured worked cell at $\tau = 43.2\,\text{Å}^2$ stopped at six different cells and of a noisy orthorhombic cell at sixteen, every one a member of $\mathcal{S}_\tau$, but on a noisy cubic cell at $\tau = 10\,\text{Å}^2$ the 400 restarts found 15 of the 16 members.[z45]

The set has to be computed, not sampled.

Near-congruence is decided by the widened closure. If two cells are τ-congruent through a superbase F reduced for the new cell, then F, carried to the reference, has all conorms at least $-\tau$ and so lies in the reference's widened closure. Near-congruence is therefore decided without a search over operators: compute $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}_R)$ once, reduce the new cell once, and pair its reduced superbase with each stored member. The stored set contains the connecting cell whenever one exists.

The computation is complete. If $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$, the four steps of Section 3.3 return exactly $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G})$ (Theorem 2 and Corollary 2a, Appendix A): every superbase within the band is an exact member of the idealised lattice, so enumerating the idealised closure and filtering cannot miss it. On every test lattice and band, including walls placed between τ and 4τ, the procedure returned the brute-force set.[z44] The condition is sufficient, not sharp: for the measured worked cell it allows τ up to 28.2 Å^2, and the procedure is still exact at 43.2 and 60 Å^2;[z44] for a shortest cell edge of 30 Å it allows bands up to about 28 Å^2. Idealising all small conorms together is required by the proof and loses nothing, since the closure of any partial idealisation lies inside that of the full one (Lemma A6);[z46] the threshold 4τ is what the proof requires, and on dense two-wall grids 2τ was already exact while τ was not.[z46]

Walks from the measured cell miss members. The natural alternative starts from the measured reduced cell and flips across any conorm within some band of zero. Table 5 compares four versions with the procedure above on 80 cells with walls at awkward positions; all four miss members. The cause is a member reachable only through a non-member: with walls at 1.2τ and 0.5τ, the flip across the first gives a conorm of -1.2τ, outside the band, and only a second flip, across the other wall, reaches a member of depth 0.7τ. On the idealised lattice both walls are zero and both flips cost nothing. Idealising at τ rather than 4τ fails on the same configuration.[z44] Such members occur

only where three walls meet in a triangle, when one small conorm $z \leq \tau$ and the other lies between τ and $z + \tau$; their most negative conorm is the difference of two small conorms; they carry no symmetry (a lattice on such a difference-wall has point group $\bar{1}$); and they are ordinary alternative reduced cells to which a second measurement of the lattice can reduce.[z46]

Table 5. *Four walks on the measured metric, and the procedure of Section 3.3, against brute force on 80 cells with walls at awkward positions (orthorhombic, cubic, plate, monoclinic and hexagonal zero patterns;* $\tau = 0.1$ *and* 0.5 *of* $\lambda_1/32$*).*

procedure	cells with a wrong set
flip wherever $\lvert p\rvert \leq \tau$, keep only cells within the band	13
flip wherever $\lvert p\rvert \leq \tau$, filter at the end	13
flip wherever $\lvert p\rvert \leq 2\tau$, keep only cells within the band	13
flip wherever $\lvert p\rvert \leq 2\tau$, filter at the end	2
idealise at 4τ, enumerate the exact closure, filter	0

The idealised lattice is not a symmetry assignment. Setting the small conorms to zero resembles the most generous choice a Le Page search makes, but what comes back is different. Le Page returns a point group, asserted. The idealisation returns the closure of a lattice Λ^*, and asserts nothing: Λ^*'s symmetries are candidates with prices, and the filter removes the members the measurement does not support. Nor is Λ^* in general of higher symmetry. Idealisation imposes zeros but no equalities, so a measured primitive monoclinic cell whose only small conorms are its two symmetry-forced walls idealises to a primitive monoclinic lattice. What Λ^* always has is a zero pattern at least as degenerate as the measured cell's. Only when the small conorms are the walls of a higher class does Λ^* lie in that class, and then its extra symmetries are the pseudo-symmetries, each priced.

A worked filter. Table 6 shows the procedure on the measured worked cell. The reduced superbase has conorms $(49.5, 1588.9, 2444.7, 4.2, 847.5, 4.5)\,\text{Å}^2$ in the slots da, db, dc, ab, ac, bc. At $\tau = 43.2\,\text{Å}^2$ the three conorms below $4\tau = 172.8$ are set to zero and equation (1) gives an orthorhombic idealised cell, $29.1 \times 39.9 \times 57.4\,\text{Å}$. Its closure has sixteen members; each row gives one as a word in the flips of Table 1

and its six conorms under the *measured* metric, computed from the member's integer coordinates with no further reduction. A member is kept when its smallest conorm is at least $-\tau$; nothing is inherited, and several kept members have a parent on the walk that is rejected.[z45] The sign of a conorm belongs to the member: $p_{ab} = +4.2$ in F_0, -4.2 after the flip ab, $+4.2$ after flipping back. Deeper members carry integer combinations of the small conorms — $-(49.5+4.2)$, $-(49.5-4.5)$, $-(49.5+4.2+8.7)$ — and those combinations, not the measured conorms, decide when a member enters. One enumeration serves every band up to 211 Å^2, where 4τ reaches the next conorm: the widened closure has six members for $8.7 \le \tau < 45.0$, the six members of the unperturbed cell at the same integer coordinates; seven at 45.1; nine at 50; fourteen at 60; sixteen from 62.5.[z45] The members entering at 45.0 carry the near-orthorhombic twofolds, so a member's depth is the band at which the pseudo-symmetry it carries becomes visible, and its symmetries' prices say how far the measurement is from it.

Table 6. *The filter on the measured worked cell. Each row is a member of the idealised lattice's closure, named by a word in the flips of Table 1 from the reduced cell e; the six numbers are its conorms under the measured metric tensor, slots da, db, dc, ab, ac, bc, in Å^2; "enters at" is its depth. At $\tau = 43.2$ the six members above the line are kept.*

word	*da*	*db*	*dc*	*ab*	*ac*	*bc*	enters at
e	49.5	1588.9	2444.7	4.2	847.5	4.5	0
ab	851.7	1593.1	2440.6	−4.2	53.7	8.7	4.2
bc	45.0	8.7	2449.3	1593.4	852.0	−4.5	4.5
ab.bc.db	2453.8	−4.5	847.5	1606.3	57.9	−4.2	4.5
ab.bc	842.9	4.5	2449.3	1601.8	62.5	−8.7	8.7
bc.db	2458.0	−8.7	53.7	1602.1	843.3	4.2	8.7
da	−49.5	2494.3	1638.4	53.7	897.0	−45.0	49.5
da.ab.bc	942.0	−45.0	1593.4	2556.7	12.9	−8.7	45.0
da.ab.ac	−49.5	2543.8	1588.9	954.9	−4.2	12.9	49.5
da.ab	950.7	2548.0	1584.7	−53.7	4.2	8.7	53.7
ab.ac	49.5	1539.3	2494.3	905.4	−53.7	62.5	53.7
bc.db.dc	45.0	2511.7	−53.7	1548.4	897.0	57.9	53.7
ab.ac.bc.ac	1610.5	959.1	2565.5	−4.2	−8.7	−53.7	53.7
da.ab.bc.ac	2569.6	−57.9	1606.3	954.9	−12.9	4.2	57.9
ab.ac.bc	−12.9	967.8	2556.7	1601.8	8.7	−62.5	62.5
ab.bc.ac	1664.2	−57.9	2511.7	905.4	−62.5	53.7	62.5

4.4. Reindexing from one reduced cell

The operators relating two settings of one lattice are one operator composed with the lattice symmetries, and each is an operator between a member of one closure and a member of the other. On the measured worked pair at $\tau = 43.2\,\text{Å}^2$, pairing the six members of the unperturbed cell with the six of the perturbed one gives twelve candidates at a price of $14.4\,\text{Å}^2$ — four distinct operators, the $2/m$ coset, at a price equal to the perturbation — and nothing else below $1378\,\text{Å}^2$. At $\tau = 60\,\text{Å}^2$ the members carrying the near-orthorhombic symmetry are present: fourteen members give twelve candidates at 14.4, ten at 150.7 and nothing below $992\,\text{Å}^2$.[z39] The band decides which pseudo-symmetries are offered.

A new cell needs no closure of its own. For fifteen references near orthorhombic, cubic, plate, monoclinic and hexagonal corners, each with twelve new cells carrying a random metric error of declared size and a random reindexing, the new cell's single reduced superbase was always a member of the reference's widened closure at the correct integer coordinates, and the true operator was always among the candidates: 180 of 180, with the band set from the declared error as in Appendix B.[z47]

Completeness of the stored set matters. A new cell constructed so that its only reduced superbase is a difference-wall member of an orthorhombic corner was matched against two stored sets of the reference. The set built as in Section 3.3 offers candidates at 7.83, 8.01 and $8.84\,\text{Å}^2$, each with its negative; the set built by idealising only at τ offers the first two and has lost the third, which is $\pm\mathbf{I}$, the true operator.[z46] The best candidate is still found, through a pseudo-symmetry, but the reported coset is incomplete.

That the true operator is among the candidates can be guaranteed before matching. If the new cell's metric tensor, in the reference frame, is within η of the reference's, and V is the sum of the squared lengths of the new cell's three reduced vectors, then

the band $\tau = \sqrt{2}\,\eta\,V/(\lambda_{\min} - \eta)$, with $\lambda_{\min}$ the smallest eigenvalue of the reference metric tensor, suffices (Proposition 3, Appendix A). The guarantee held in all 180 cases but is conservative, with median 13η against a band near 3η that was in fact enough.[z47]

5. Discussion

Relation to earlier work. The ingredients are classical. Selling (1874) and Delone (1932) introduced the reduction and the sorts; Conway & Sloane (1992) the conorm language and the identity used in Appendix A; Kurlin (2026) the finiteness and enumeration of obtuse superbases; Andrews, Bernstein and Sauter the S^6 formalism in which the flips are the boundary transformations and distances are measured across them (Andrews *et al.*, 2019; Andrews & Bernstein, 2023). Delone obtained his sorts from patterns of zeros and equalities, so Section 4.2 is a confirmation, not a discovery. What is added here is: the accounting of Table 4, which separates the symmetries visible in a reduced cell from those that are operators to other cells and shows that symmetries never cross between cell shapes; the widened closure with its uniqueness and union characterisation; the idealisation at 4τ with its completeness theorem and the demonstration that walks from the measured cell are incomplete; and the reindexing guarantee from one reduced cell. In the language of algebra the closure is a groupoid — objects, invertible arrows, consistent composition (Brandt, 1927; Brown, 2006) — and the symmetries form the action groupoid of the point group on the members; nothing beyond the definitions is used.

What is proved and what is checked. Proved in Appendix A, from Kurlin's results and two integer constants obtained by exhaustive enumeration, are: the uniqueness and union characterisation of the widened closure; the completeness of idealise–enumerate–filter when $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$; the generation of the closure by flips and swaps; the nesting of

partial idealisations; and the reindexing guarantee. Exhaustive but on generic lattices with random values, hence computations rather than proofs, are the identification of the 24 sorts and the counts of Table 4; exact integer arithmetic would close that gap. Checked in every case tested but not proved are that idealising at 2τ suffices, that the true operator is found at the band set from the error rather than only at the conservative guarantee, and that the operators accepted within a band are exactly one operator composed with the idealised lattice's symmetries priced within it.

The frame. Statements about the widened closure are in terms of τ, a band on conorms, and need no frame. Converting an error on the metric tensor into τ does, because the Frobenius norm of an error depends on the basis. Appendix B gives the exact relation between a metric error and each conorm shift, the worst-case factors by zero pattern (up to $2\sqrt{3}$ in some cubic frames, so that $\tau = 3\eta$ is not a worst-case guarantee everywhere), a frame-free bound and the covariance route.

Implementation. The procedure of Section 3.3 replaces the band-limited walk previously used in the `agentsg` library, which Table 5 shows to be incomplete; the checks of Appendix C implement the procedure directly.

6. Conclusions

The Selling closure of a lattice contains, in one finite and complete set, every symmetry and every operator between alternative reduced cells, and a single reduced cell shows only the symmetries that relabel it. The closure is fixed by the Delone sort. For a measured cell, near-congruence within a band is decided by the widened closure, which is unique, equals the union of nearby exact closures, and is computed completely by idealising at 4τ, enumerating and filtering. Reindexing a new cell onto a reference then reads one operator from that set, from a single reduced cell of the new cell, with a guarantee that the true operator is among those read.

Appendix A
Proofs

Terms. Write a lattice vector in any basis, $x = n_1v_1 + n_2v_2 + n_3v_3$ with integer n_i, and record whether each coordinate is even or odd. This sorts the lattice into eight *parity classes*; two vectors are in the same class exactly when their difference is twice a lattice vector, so the classes do not depend on the basis (the classes of $\Lambda/2\Lambda$). One class is the doubled vectors; the other seven are used here. A *partial sum* of a superbase is the sum of some of its four vectors; since the four add to zero, there are seven partial sums up to sign, one in each of the seven classes, and for the monoclinic superbase $(-a-b-c, a, b, c)$ they are a, b, c, $a+b$, $a+c$, $b+c$ and $a+b+c$. The fact used (Conway & Sloane, 1992; Kurlin, 2026, Lemmas 2.4, 2.7 and A.1) is that a superbase is obtuse exactly when each of its partial sums is a shortest vector of its parity class. The *excess* $e_c(F) = |v_c(F)|^2 - \mu_c$ of a superbase F in class c is the squared length of its partial sum $v_c(F)$ in that class minus the squared length μ_c of the shortest vector of the class; an obtuse superbase has zero excess in every class. A partial sum is written $w = \sum s_iv_i$ with $s \in \{0,1\}^4$ marking which vectors it adds; a vector of the same parity class has coordinates $s + 2k$ with k integer. Every lattice vector $x = \sum c_iv_i$ satisfies Selling's identity

$$|x|^2 = \sum_{i<j} p_{ij}\,(c_i - c_j)^2, \tag{3}$$

whatever the signs of the conorms, because the four vectors sum to zero. For a superbase F and two metrics, $\delta_F(\mathbf{G}, \mathbf{G}')$ is the largest change among F's six conorms.

Proposition 1. $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}) = \{F : F \in \mathcal{G}(\mathbf{G}')$ for some $\mathbf{G}'$ with $\delta_F(\mathbf{G}, \mathbf{G}') \le \tau\}$. *Proof.* ($\supseteq$) If F is obtuse for $\mathbf{G}'$ and $\delta_F(\mathbf{G}, \mathbf{G}') \le \tau$, every conorm of F under $\mathbf{G}$ is at least $-\tau$. ($\subseteq$) If $F \in \mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G})$, the metric whose conorms in the frame of F are $\max(p_{ij}, 0)$ exceeds $\mathbf{G}$ by a positive semidefinite term, so it is positive definite; F is obtuse for it,

at δ_F equal to the depth of F. Each negative conorm must move at least to zero, so no nearer metric makes F obtuse. □

Lemma A1 (class excess identity). Let F be any superbase, $w = \sum s_i v_i$ a partial sum and w' a vector of its parity class with coordinates $s + 2k$. Then $|w|^2 - |w'|^2 = -4\sum p_{ij}\gamma_{ij}$, with $\gamma_{ij} = \Delta k(\Delta k+d)$, $\Delta k = k_i - k_j$, $d = s_i - s_j$; each γ_{ij} is a non-negative integer, zero exactly when $\Delta k \in \{0, -d\}$. *Proof.* Equation (3), $(d + 2\Delta k)^2 - d^2 = 4\Delta k(\Delta k + d)$, and $t(t + d) \geq 0$ for integers t and $d \in \{-1, 0, 1\}$.

Lemma A2 (class gap). Let Λ^* be obtained from F_0 by setting its conorms $\leq \theta$ to zero, be positive definite, and let m^* be the smallest conorm of F_0 above θ. A superbase not obtuse for Λ^* has $e_c \geq 4m^*$ in some class. *Proof.* In the frame of F_0, with w the partial sum of F_0 in class c — a shortest vector of its class for $\mathbf{G}$ and for Λ^* — Lemma A1 gives $e_c(F) = 4\sum p^0_{ij}\gamma_{ij}$, a sum of non-negative terms, and the excess for Λ^* is the same sum over the slots above θ. If those terms vanish in all seven classes, every partial sum of F is a shortest vector of its class for Λ^* and F is obtuse for it; otherwise some $\gamma_{ij} \geq 1$ multiplies a $p^0_{ij} \geq m^*$.

Lemma A3 (small excess in the band). If $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$ and every conorm of F is at least $-\tau$, then $e_c(F) \leq 16\tau$ in every class. *Proof.* Call a slot large if $p_{ij} > 8\tau$, and let N be the negative slots. The large slots connect the four vectors, since otherwise a split crossed only by slots with $p_{ij} \leq 8\tau$ has a partial sum of squared length at most $32\tau < \lambda_1$. With w' a shortest vector of the class, Lemma A1 in the frame of F gives $0 \leq e_c(F) = 4\sum_N |p_{ij}|\gamma_{ij} - 4\sum_{p_{ij}>0} p_{ij}\gamma_{ij}$, so $\sum_{\text{large}} p\gamma \leq \tau\sum_N \gamma$. If a large γ were positive, Lemma A4(ii) would give $8\tau\sum_{\text{large}}\gamma < \tau\sum_N\gamma \leq 8\tau\sum_{\text{large}}\gamma$; so the large γ vanish, and Lemma A4(i) gives $e_c \leq 4\tau \cdot 4$.

Lemma A4 (two constants on four points). Let L be a set of slots connecting the four vectors and N disjoint from L. (i) If $\gamma_{ij} = 0$ on L, then $\sum_N \gamma_{ij} \leq 4$. (ii) $\sum_N \gamma_{ij} \leq 8\sum_L \gamma_{ij}$. Both are attained. *Proof.* In (i) $|\Delta k| \leq 1$ on L, so with $k_0 = 0$ all $|k_i| \leq 3$,

and the maximum is a finite enumeration over the 38 connected slot sets, the sets N and the 14 partial sums. In (ii) the ratio is enumerated for $|k_i| \le 15$; beyond, $Q = \sum_L \Delta k^2 > 75$, and $\sum_N \gamma \le \rho Q + \sqrt{|N|\rho Q}$, $\sum_L \gamma \ge Q - \sqrt{|L|Q}$, with $\rho \le 3 + 2\sqrt{2}$ the largest generalised eigenvalue of $\sum_N \Delta k^2$ against $\sum_L \Delta k^2$, keep it below 8 for every pattern. Equality in (ii): $L = \{01, 02, 13\}$, $N = \{03, 12, 23\}$, $s = (0, 0, 1, 1)$.[z44]

Theorem 2. Let F_0 be obtuse for $\mathbf{G}$, $\lambda_1 > 32\tau$, and Λ^* obtained by setting every conorm of F_0 that is at most 4τ to zero. Then Λ^* is positive definite and $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}) = \{F \in \mathcal{G}(\Lambda^*) : p_{ij}(F; \mathbf{G}) \ge -\tau\}$. *Proof.* If the slots of F_0 above 4τ did not connect the four vectors, some partial sum would have squared length at most $16\tau < \lambda_1$. The inclusion $\supseteq$ is the definition. For $F \in \mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G})$, Lemma A3 gives $e_c(F) \le 16\tau$ in every class; the smallest surviving conorm exceeds 4τ, so Lemma A2 makes F obtuse for Λ^*. □

Corollary 2a (operator form). Under the hypotheses of Theorem 2, let $\mathbf{W}_1, \ldots, \mathbf{W}_m$ be the integer changes of basis from F_0 to the members of $\mathcal{G}(\Lambda^*)$. Then $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}) = \{F_0\mathbf{W}_k : \ p_{ij}(F_0\mathbf{W}_k; \mathbf{G}) \ge -\tau \text{ for all } ij\}$. *Proof.* The members of $\mathcal{G}(\Lambda^*)$ are the superbases $F_0\mathbf{W}_k$; the $\mathbf{W}_k$ are integer matrices independent of the metric, so the same superbases read with $\mathbf{G}$ are the right-hand side of Theorem 2. □

Lemma A5 (generation). Every operator between members of the closure, and every symmetry, is a sequence of flips at zero conorms followed by a swap. *Proof.* The members are reached from F_0 by flips at zero conorms (Kurlin, 2026, Lemmas 4.1–4.5), so flips and swaps connect all members. A symmetry maps F_0 to an obtuse superbase, which is a member; as a matrix it is the flip path from F_0 to that member followed by a swap.

Lemma A6 (nesting). If $Z' \subseteq Z$ are sets of conorms of F_0 set to zero, every member of the closure for Z' is a member of the closure for Z. *Proof.* By Kurlin's enumeration (2026, Lemmas 4.1–4.5) the conorms of every member of the closure of a lattice are

non-negative integer combinations of the non-zero conorms of its reduced superbase; the combinations are the same for every lattice with that zero pattern and are reproduced by the enumerations in [z46]. Setting further free conorms to zero keeps every such combination non-negative, so a member for Z' remains obtuse for Z.

Lemma A7 (sorts as closed patterns of equalities). Fix a zero pattern Z and let Π_Z be the permutations of the six conorm slots produced by the members of the closure under all swaps that keep the zeros in place. A lattice with zero pattern Z and a given pattern P of equal conorms has exactly the symmetries in Π_Z that preserve each class of P. *Proof.* A symmetry maps F_0 to a member with the same conorm vector, so it is an element of Π_Z that fixes the values; the members are complete by Kurlin's theorem, so no symmetry is missed. A permutation fixes a vector of values exactly when it preserves each class of equal values. Hence the pattern of equalities of a generic lattice of a sort is the orbit partition of its symmetry group, and every such closed pattern is the pattern of the generic lattices of one sort.

Proposition 3 (reindexing guarantee). Let $\mathbf{G}'_N$ be the new cell's metric written in the reference frame, $\|\mathbf{G}'_N - \mathbf{G}_R\|_F \le \eta < \lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{G}_R)$, let F_N be its reduced superbase with basis vectors of summed squared length V, and let $\tau \ge \sqrt{2}\,\eta\,V/(\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{G}_R) - \eta)$ with $\lambda_1(\mathbf{G}_R) > 32\tau$. Then F_N, with its true integer coefficients in the reference frame, is a member of $\mathcal{S}_\tau(\mathbf{G}_R)$, the procedure of Section 3.3 produces it, and pairing it with the new cell's reduced superbase proposes the true operator. *Proof.* Let u_i be the coordinates of F_N's basis vectors in the reference frame and $\Delta = \mathbf{G}'_N - \mathbf{G}_R$. Then $u_i^{\mathsf{T}}\mathbf{G}'_N u_i \ge (\lambda_{\min}(\mathbf{G}_R) - \eta)|u_i|^2$, so $\sum |u_i|^2 \le V/(\lambda_{\min} - \eta)$. In F_N's own frame the error is $U\Delta U^{\mathsf{T}}$, of Frobenius norm at most $\sum |u_i|^2\,\eta$, and in its own frame every conorm shift is at most $\sqrt{2}$ times that norm (Appendix B). The conorms of F_N under $\mathbf{G}'_N$ are non-negative, so under $\mathbf{G}_R$ they are at least $-\tau$, and Theorem 2 applies. The proposed operator for the pair is the change of basis between the two copies of F_N, which is the

true one. □

Appendix B
From a metric error to a band

A conorm is linear in the metric, so a metric error $\Delta\mathbf{G}$ shifts the conorm of a member with coordinate vectors u_i, u_j by exactly $-u_i^{\mathsf{T}}\Delta\mathbf{G}\,u_j$; by Cauchy–Schwarz in the Frobenius product the shift is at most $c_{ij}\eta$, with $c_{ij} = \|\operatorname{sym}(u_i u_j^{\mathsf{T}})\|_F = [\frac{1}{2}(|u_i|^2|u_j|^2+(u_i\cdot u_j)^2)]^{1/2}$, and an error along $\operatorname{sym}(u_i u_j^{\mathsf{T}})$ attains it. Every exact member of a stored closure survives in the widened closure of the measurement exactly when τ is at least the coverage bound $\tau_{\mathrm{cov}} = \max(c_{ij}\eta - p_{ij})$, read off the stored closure.[z36] For the worked cells $\eta = 14.4\,\text{Å}^2$ and $\tau = 3\eta = 43.2\,\text{Å}^2$. Member vectors are not confined to $\{-1, 0, 1\}$; on two and three walls they carry entries up to 3. On walls the largest constant is $\sqrt{2}$ with one zero, $\sqrt{5}$ with two, and with three zeros $2\sqrt{3}$ in six of the sixteen labelled cuboid frames — those whose zeros form a path with d at an interior vertex — and at most $\sqrt{5}$ otherwise; on positive slots it is at most 7.2. In a $2\sqrt{3}$ frame an adversarial error of norm η drives a member to $-3.46\,\eta$, so $\tau = 3\eta$ is not a worst-case guarantee in every frame.[z36] In a member's own frame the member is the standard superbase, whose largest constant is $\sqrt{2}$, so $\tau = \sqrt{2}\,\eta^*$ with η^* the largest error norm over the members' own frames covers every member; it is uniform but loose, 2.8 times the reduced-frame η in the median case and up to 17 times.[z36] With a covariance Σ for the metric, the variance of each member conorm is the quadratic form of Σ on $\operatorname{sym}(u_i u_j^{\mathsf{T}})$, exact in any frame, and the band can be set slot by slot.

Appendix C
Computational checks

Each mark [*znn*] refers to `manuscript/appendix_z/test_z`*nn*`_*.py` in the `agentsg` repository.

mark	what is checked
z36	shift identity; constants by zero pattern and frame; adversarial loss at 3η; frame-free bound
z39	measured worked pair: widened closure by definition; candidate operators at $\tau =$ 43.2 and 60
z44	constants 4 and 8; class gap and excess; Theorem 2 against brute force; grey zone; worked cell
z45	reduction endpoints and restarts; walks on the measured metric; the worked filter table
z46	the monoclinic example; closures of the 24 sorts; shapes = orbits; twofolds generate; coset completeness; difference-wall members; 2τ; nesting
z47	reindexing under a declared error: membership, true operator, guarantee
z48	the 24 Delone sorts reproduced from six zero patterns

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Synopsis

The set of all Selling-reduced cells of a lattice, with the integer matrices between them, holds the lattice symmetry and every alternative choice of reduced cell in one complete set. For a measured cell the set is recovered exactly by idealising the cell onto its nearest pattern of right angles, and reindexing reads one matrix from it.